Depth Repair: Social Issues in India and Telangana — mechanisms, measurement, law and administrative choices

Paper III · Unit I · Topic 3 · Original analytical supplement · 25 October 2026

Scope and status. This supplement extends the existing chapter without replacing its earlier PDF. The official syllabus spans poverty, unemployment, child labour, violence against women, regionalism, communalism, corruption, caste conflict, agricultural labour, urbanisation, displacement, environmental degradation, sustainable development, population change, agrarian distress and migration. The cases below are *hypothetical administrative illustrations*, not claims about named victims or villages. Numeric findings are accompanied by the measurement period. This is a study draft, **not an independently academically approved text**.

1. A causal map: why social problems persist despite laws and schemes

A scheme can expand formal eligibility while an individual's effective access remains unchanged. Consider a landless family whose livelihood depends on farm labour. A delayed wage payment causes borrowing; interest and travel costs erode disposable income; a seasonal move interrupts schooling; a child begins unpaid production work; and missing residence documents complicate benefits at the destination. Each link crosses an administrative boundary. The labour department may see child work, the education department absenteeism, the rural-development office payment delays, and the urban local body insecure shelter. Treating the final symptom in isolation is expensive and often ineffective.

Three mechanisms should be separated in an answer. **Resource scarcity** means insufficient land, money, water, jobs or public services. **Institutional exclusion** means that resources exist but rules, discretion, identity documents, distance, discrimination or poor grievance procedures block access. **Risk transmission** means a temporary shock becomes permanent damage through debt, lost learning, asset sales or illness. The remedies differ: investment addresses scarcity; enforceable access and audits address exclusion; insurance, prompt payments and continuity of schooling address risk transmission. An administrator should identify the binding constraint before recommending another awareness campaign.

Use an explicit chain: *shock or unequal endowment → household coping response → institutional friction → cumulative deprivation → measurable outcome*. A policy is credible when it names both the agency responsible and the indicator that would show improvement. For instance, number of inspections is an output; sustained school retention after a child-labour rescue is closer to an outcome. Likewise, registration for a welfare scheme is not equivalent to receipt of timely benefits.

2. Poverty: measurement is a political and statistical choice, not a single number

An income or consumption poverty line asks whether command over goods and services crosses a specified threshold. A multidimensional index asks whether the same household experiences weighted deprivations in selected health, education and living-standard indicators. These are different constructs: a family can improve electricity access and sanitation while earnings remain precarious; another can have income above a line while a disabled family member lacks accessible transport or healthcare. Neither measure should be presented as a complete account of social justice. The relevant question is which deprivation is being measured, for which population and period.

The National MPI discussion paper released by NITI Aayog in January 2024 projected an 11.28% headcount for 2022–23. This figure is an **estimate based on extrapolation**, not a direct enumeration of households in 2022–23 and certainly not a 2026 census. The distinction matters in a mains answer: projections can be useful for trends but cannot settle local claims about landless workers, urban renters or tribal hamlets. Survey-based measures require attention to sampling, recall periods, price adjustment and the distinction between a national mean and district heterogeneity.

A Telangana district poverty strategy should classify households by livelihood and exposure, not only by an administrative below-poverty-line tag. Dryland cultivators need crop-risk management and viable market access; agricultural labourers need predictable wage opportunities and portable entitlements; low-income Hyderabad tenants need affordable transport, rental stability and health protection. The common outcome is reduced **vulnerability to**

shocks, measured through distress debt, consumption volatility, school continuity and avoidable medical expenditure. The limitation is that integrated case management requires data safeguards: a shared beneficiary database must not become an exclusionary gatekeeper when records disagree.

3. Unemployment: distinguish inactivity, open joblessness and inadequate work

The unemployment rate uses the *labour force* as denominator. It cannot tell whether people outside the labour force are discouraged workers, full-time students, carers or others. Labour-force participation rate and worker-population ratio use population denominators; unemployment, participation and employment should therefore be read together. The Periodic Labour Force Survey distinguishes usual-status classifications from current-weekly status. Comparing a monthly CWS headline with a usual-status annual series as though they were identical creates a false trend. The annual PLFS 2025 report was published in 2026 and supplies state-level breakdowns; any quoted figure must state age group, sex, rural/urban category and reference definition.

Underemployment is not merely a smaller unemployment rate. An educated person delivering occasional services may be counted as working while experiencing unstable hours, weak bargaining power and no employment security. A woman who enters low-paid household-enterprise work may increase the participation measure without gaining control over earnings. A labour-market intervention must therefore distinguish **demand** (number of viable positions), **matching** (information and recruitment), **skills** (ability to perform tasks), **mobility** (transport, housing and safety) and **quality** (real earnings, hours, contracts and protection). Training alone cannot repair weak labour demand; a hiring subsidy cannot compensate for unsafe commuting; more jobs do not automatically resolve caste or gender discrimination.

A Telangana example is the contrast between Hyderabad's specialised technology and pharmaceutical occupations and seasonal agricultural labour in districts farther from metropolitan markets. A district skills programme should publish retention after six months, median earnings and placement by gender and social group rather than only enrolment and certificates. Because work quality is multidimensional, an answer should avoid the misleading conclusion that a decline in measured unemployment proves the absence of labour distress.

4. Child labour: the family-enterprise exception requires careful interpretation

The Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986, as amended in 2016, generally prohibits employment of children below 14, subject to tightly framed statutory exceptions, and prohibits adolescents aged 14–18 from specified hazardous occupations and processes. The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, concerns compulsory elementary education for children aged 6–14. These laws are complementary but not identical. A school enrolment record cannot establish that a child is free from work, and a workplace inspection cannot establish that the child has been reintegrated into learning.

The family-enterprise exception is particularly sensitive in subcontracted, home-based production. A child may appear to be helping relatives, while a commercial contractor controls deadlines and prices. An investigator should establish who supplies raw material, who sets output targets, whether the child misses school, whether work occurs during prohibited hours, and whether health or safety is endangered. The objective is to identify the real economic relationship rather than accept the label 'family assistance' at face value. Children must not be treated as offenders. A rescue without schooling, family income stabilisation and follow-up can result in re-entry into work.

In Telangana, a hypothetical migrant household moving between brick-making or construction sites illustrates the need for portable school admissions, bridge learning, language support and tracking across districts. Administrative indicators should include attendance sustained for two academic terms, age-appropriate learning, rehabilitation access and timely prosecution of exploitative employers where evidence warrants it. **Counterpoint:** a blanket punitive approach that destroys adult livelihoods without income support may worsen household vulnerability. Effective enforcement therefore couples child protection with adult labour rights.

5. Violence against women: distinguish reporting, prevalence and institutional response

Police-recorded crime statistics depend on both the underlying incidence and willingness or ability to report. More recorded complaints may reflect increased access to police, greater trust, changed legal definitions or increased harm; the direction cannot be inferred from the count alone. Surveys, service-use data, court outcomes and qualitative studies answer different questions. A careful answer never treats a lower reporting rate as proof of safety or a higher reporting rate as proof that a policy has failed.

The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005, recognises physical, sexual, verbal, emotional and economic abuse and provides civil protective remedies. The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, establishes workplace duties and complaint mechanisms. Their institutional settings differ; neither substitutes for criminal-law processes where offences are alleged. The practical problem is often the path between complaint and relief: safe disclosure, confidentiality, immediate protection, access to healthcare, housing, legal aid and freedom from retaliation. For women in informal work, domestic work or small enterprises, workplace redressal structures may be difficult to access in practice.

An urban Telangana district can map gaps in last-mile transport, shelter availability and protection-officer workloads without disclosing survivor identities. Measure time to first protective action, compliance with orders and continuity of livelihood. **Limitation:** an apparently efficient complaint dashboard can expose survivors if identifiers are widely shared. Data minimisation and restricted access are essential, not optional administrative details.

6. Caste conflict, agricultural labour and land relations

Caste conflict cannot be reduced to personal prejudice. Control over land, credit, local political offices, tenancy, social networks and access to public goods can make caste hierarchies economically self-reinforcing. Agricultural labourers may experience a triple dependency on the same employer for wages, housing and emergency loans. A demand for statutory wages or access to common land can therefore be experienced as a challenge to local power, increasing the risk of retaliation. Women labourers may face additional vulnerabilities in wage setting and harassment. A mains answer should connect **social hierarchy** → **bargaining asymmetry** → **labour-market segmentation** → **unequal outcomes**.

The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, supplies a specific legal framework for defined atrocities and associated procedures. It does not replace the need for reliable police investigation, witness protection, land-record correction or fair public-service delivery. The Constitution's equality and anti-discrimination guarantees must be analysed alongside the actual capacity to enforce them. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005, can improve a rural worker's fallback option, potentially increasing bargaining power, but delayed wages and insufficient work demand weaken that effect. A programme guaranteeing up to 100 days per eligible rural household is not the same as 100 days automatically received by each individual.

A Telangana case could examine a village where workers complain that wages differ by gender and social group. The administration should verify wage records, conduct confidential interviews, inspect worksite conditions, enforce applicable protections and provide a grievance channel outside the employer's influence. A simplistic response that relies solely on mediation may leave structural intimidation intact. Outcome indicators include actual wage parity, safe reporting and continuity of work—not the number of meetings convened.

7. Development and displacement: compensation is not livelihood restoration

Infrastructure may provide broad public benefits while concentrating costs on particular families. Physical displacement means relocation of residence; economic displacement includes loss of fields, grazing access, fishing, forest produce, customers or transport routes even where a home remains standing. The Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013, includes provisions for social impact assessment, consultation and rehabilitation, subject to the Act's application and specified exceptions. A district official must examine the legally applicable acquisition route rather than assume identical procedures govern every project or land category.

The core analytical distinction is **replacement of an asset** versus **restoration of a livelihood system**. A cash payment for land may not replace shared water access, local credit, nearby markets or a woman's informal income. Landowners, tenants, sharecroppers and landless labourers can bear different losses; a survey that records only titleholders

understates the affected population. In Scheduled Areas, additional constitutional and statutory safeguards may apply, requiring separate verification of land and community rights. Public hearings are not meaningful when documents are inaccessible or participation is coerced.

Consider a hypothetical Telangana reservoir expansion. Before acquisition, map household and community assets, crop cycles, common resources, occupational dependencies and potential host-site services. After relocation, monitor actual earnings, school attendance, potable water, health access and grievances over several years. A narrow project completion certificate proves construction, not social rehabilitation. **Counterargument:** delayed infrastructure also imposes costs on prospective beneficiaries. The defensible position is transparent alternatives analysis and fair burden-sharing, not an automatic rejection or approval of every project.

8. Agrarian distress: separate yield risk, price risk, credit risk and tenancy risk

A farmer's gross crop revenue is approximately *quantity sold* × *realised price*. Net farm income also depends on seed, fertiliser, hired labour, irrigation, machinery rental, interest, transport, storage and household consumption needs. A good harvest can coincide with low net returns when market prices collapse; a high price can fail to help when drought destroys output. Yield insurance and procurement address different risks. A debt waiver can provide short-term relief but may bypass tenant cultivators borrowing informally, while recurring input costs and weak marketing remain unresolved. Agricultural labourers may lose wages during crop failure even when they do not own farmland or qualify for owner-focused assistance.

Telangana's dryland cropping systems and groundwater dependence make water risk highly location-specific. A blanket prescription to 'increase irrigation' can raise extraction and energy costs if aquifer recharge and cropping patterns are ignored. A better district approach maps crop-water suitability, market concentration, storage access, extension quality, tenancy documentation and non-farm employment. The analytical unit should include the **farm household and hired workers**, not only land title. Rural mental-health and financial counselling services are relevant as part of a broader welfare response; never reduce farmer distress to a single psychological explanation or publish unsupported suicide totals.

Evaluate policy by real net returns, debt-servicing burden, timely payments, groundwater trends and risk distribution across owners, tenants and labourers. Avoid attributing any one year's agricultural outcome entirely to a single scheme without considering rainfall, prices and other concurrent factors.

9. Migration and urbanisation: portability, informal settlements and city governance

Migration may be seasonal, circular, permanent, voluntary or distress-driven; many households combine village and city livelihoods. It is not inherently a failure. Remittances can diversify risk and finance education, while mobility can expose workers to exploitative contractors, insecure housing and gaps in school continuity. Administrative systems built around a permanent address are poorly suited to people who move frequently. The right response is portable access to essential services, credible wage enforcement and safe accommodation, not an assumption that every migrant should be prevented from moving.

Urbanisation has several measures: the share of population living in urban areas, absolute urban population growth, expansion of built-up land and the concentration of economic activity. These are not interchangeable. Hyderabad's metropolitan growth brings productivity and services, but congestion, high rents, air pollution and flood exposure can transfer costs to low-income settlements. A drain encroachment policy must balance environmental and public-safety needs with due process, livelihood consequences and resettlement options. Moving a household farther from jobs can raise transport expenses enough to undermine an otherwise improved dwelling.

A hypothetical worker family living near a Musi tributary faces flood risk but also proximity to jobs. A fair programme should disclose hazard maps, offer accessible hearings, identify realistic relocation options and track commuting time, school continuity and income after movement. The key test is whether a plan reduces **total risk and deprivation**, rather than simply removing visible informal housing from a map.

10. Population, environment and sustainability: avoid demographic alarmism

The phrase 'population explosion' in the syllabus should be treated analytically, not as an invitation to stigmatise large families. Population change depends on fertility, mortality, migration and age structure. Even after fertility falls, a youthful population can continue growing through demographic momentum. A lower total fertility rate does not automatically solve unemployment, and a higher elderly share creates different care and pension challenges. Rights-based reproductive healthcare, women's education, health access and informed choice are more defensible than coercive demographic targets.

Environmental degradation often reflects cumulative externalities: one enterprise's discharge, many households' waste, loss of wetlands and inadequate sewage treatment can combine to damage water quality. Poor communities frequently face greater exposure while contributing less to pollution. Sustainable development therefore has at least three tests: ecological viability, distribution of benefits and burdens, and institutional accountability over time. An environmental clearance or planting target is an administrative output; changes in measured air or water quality and ecosystem function are outcomes. Distinguish the *polluter-pays principle* from the mistaken assumption that a fee licenses unlimited damage.

For Telangana, urban lake restoration and dryland groundwater governance are useful paired cases. Lake beautification without catchment sewage control will have limited effects; groundwater subsidies without extraction management can worsen long-run depletion. Good policy combines monitoring, enforcement, public participation, alternative livelihoods where restrictions are imposed, and independent evaluation. A mains conclusion should emphasise **intergenerational fairness** rather than claiming every economic-environmental trade-off has an effortless win-win solution.

11. Communalism, regionalism and corruption: constitutional safeguards with implementation capacity

Regional identity can be a legitimate claim for representation, cultural dignity and more equitable public investment; it becomes exclusionary when rights are denied to people based on language or origin. Telangana's statehood history illustrates the distinction between constitutional territorial reorganisation and hostility toward individual migrants. A strong answer explains grievance, institutional channel, democratic mobilisation and safeguards for minorities and residents. Similarly, secularism in India is not equivalent to an absence of religion from society. Constitutional commitments to equality, freedom of conscience and religious rights require public institutions to protect individuals without selective enforcement.

Communal conflict often grows when misinformation, elite incentives, residential segregation and weak enforcement reinforce each other. Administrators must distinguish protected expression from incitement or violence under applicable law and act proportionately. Preventive coordination, credible public communication and independent investigation matter more than generic appeals for harmony. Claims about a particular incident should not be inserted without a verifiable primary record.

Corruption includes petty extraction at service counters, collusion in procurement and systemic capture of regulation. Digitising an application can reduce face-to-face discretion but can also centralise gatekeeping or hide algorithmic exclusion. The Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, as amended in 2018, must be understood alongside procurement controls, transparency, internal audit, conflict-of-interest rules and whistleblower safeguards. Measure the time and cost to obtain a service, complaint resolution and audit exceptions—not merely the number of online transactions.

12. Three integrated administrative cases for answer enrichment

Case A — seasonal migration and child work. A family leaves a dryland village for construction work; a teenager stops attending school and assists at a subcontracted site. The response should document the actual work relationship, prevent hazardous exploitation, enrol the child without avoidable documentation barriers, stabilise adult wages and coordinate origin/destination school records. **Trade-off:** prosecution alone may remove income; welfare without labour enforcement may leave exploitation untouched. **Indicator:** school attendance and learning after six months, not rescue numbers alone.

Case B — reservoir, tenant farmer and agricultural labour. A proposed irrigation project acquires titled fields but overlooks sharecroppers, seasonal workers and common grazing access. The district team should map livelihood dependence and the applicable land-acquisition, rehabilitation and Scheduled Area safeguards, consult affected groups and verify post-relocation earnings. **Trade-off:** downstream irrigation benefits are real, but concentrated losses require mitigation. **Indicator:** livelihood restoration by affected category rather than compensation disbursal alone.

Case C — flood-risk resettlement in metropolitan Hyderabad. A settlement near a drainage channel faces recurrent flooding and proposed clearance. Technical hazard evidence must be made accessible, housing options must be evaluated against jobs and schools, and grievances heard before coercive action where law requires it. **Trade-off:** in-situ protection may be costly, but remote relocation can destroy incomes. **Indicator:** lower flood exposure without increased commuting, dropout or debt.

13. Mains writing architecture: compare mechanisms, laws and indicators

For a 10-mark question, begin with a definition and one sentence establishing the tension. Use **Background / Root causes / Institutional framework / Telangana illustration / Limits / Way forward / Conclusion** as compact subheadings. Under each, add causal explanation rather than naming schemes. A law should be connected to the right it creates, the institution that implements it and the practical barrier to access. A statistic must state the reference year and denominator. A balanced answer distinguishes an intervention's intended benefit from a credible implementation failure. Avoid six identical 'awareness, training, monitoring' recommendations: tailor the instrument to the problem—wage payment for labour distress, land and livelihood restoration for displacement, survivor safety for violence, portable schooling for migrant children, groundwater management for dryland distress.

14. Evidence register and limits (editorial; source page numbers omitted)

  | Primary source / date | Verified proposition | Evidence limitation |

  | NITI Aayog, *Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005–06*, January 2024 | 2022–23 MPI headcount of 11.28% is extrapolated from earlier survey trend | Not a directly observed 2022–23 household census or 2026 poverty rate |

  | MoSPI, *Annual PLFS 2025*, published May 2026 | State tables distinguish usual-status employment measures; Telangana all-ages usual-status UR 5.0% (rural + urban, persons) | Different age groups, CWS and later monthly bulletins not interchangeable |

  | India Code, RFCTLARR Act 2013, effective January 2014 | Statutory SIA, acquisition, compensation and rehabilitation architecture | Application, exceptions, amendments and local rules require case-specific review |

  | Ministry of Labour and Employment, Child and Adolescent Labour framework, 1986/2016 | Child employment generally prohibited with constrained exceptions; adolescent hazardous work restricted | Need current official consolidated text and schedules before advising on a real case |

  | NREGA Act 2005, statutory framework | Demand-driven rural wage guarantee for eligible households, not an individual universal payment | Administrative actual person-days and payment timeliness not audited here |

  | PWDVA 2005; POSH Act 2013 | Distinct domestic-protection and workplace-redressal regimes | Local institutional performance not independently measured |

  | SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act 1989 | Specific statutory protection against defined atrocities | No inference about actual incidence from registered-case totals alone |

  | Telangana district examples | Mechanisms of dryland risk, migration, metropolitan housing and land conflict | Illustrations are analytical, not audited local incidents or casualty statistics |

Sources for verification (editorial links, not claims of independent approval):

- https://www.niti.gov.in/sites/default/files/2024-01/MPI-22_NITI-Aayog20254.pdf

- https://mospi.gov.in/uploads/publications_reports/publications_reports1780040415321_0624fb13-fb47-40bc-b470-7c7e9635c3ef_PLFS_2025_F_REV_29052026.pdf

- https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/13035/1/right_to_fair_compensation_act_2013.pdf

- https://labour.gov.in/acts/child-labour-16062014

Academic gate: This repair adds causal depth and source discipline. It does not independently validate every legacy statement, confer academic approval, authenticate official PYQs, or replace the existing PDF.

Appendix A. Fifteen additional original explained MCQs (Questions 16–30)

These are original practice questions, not authenticated commission PYQs.

16. A district publishes a rising number of child-labour rescues. What further indicator best establishes sustained success?

A. Number of press releases

B. School attendance and learning after reintegration

C. Number of inspections only

D. Number of temporary shelters

Answer: B. Rescue is an immediate administrative output; sustained educational reintegration better reflects the intended outcome.

17. Why is the NITI Aayog 11.28% figure for 2022–23 not a direct poverty census?

A. It is a nominal GDP growth rate

B. It is a projected MPI headcount based on prior trends

C. It counts only Hyderabad residents

D. It is the urban unemployment rate

Answer: B. The January 2024 discussion paper explicitly uses extrapolation; the measure is multidimensional, not a directly enumerated monetary-poverty rate.

18. Which pair uses the correct PLFS denominator?

A. UR/population and LFPR/labour force

B. UR/labour force and LFPR/population

C. Both use employed persons

D. Both use total households

Answer: B. UR concerns unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, whereas LFPR is labour force relative to population.

19. A farm household reports a good harvest but negative net returns. Which explanation is most plausible?

A. Harvest volume always determines profit

B. Input costs and realised prices can offset yield

C. Crop insurance guarantees profit

D. Tenancy has no effect on income

Answer: B. Farm profitability depends on realised price and production/financing costs, not only quantity harvested.

20. Why might land compensation fail to restore displaced livelihoods?

A. All affected households are titleholders

B. Shared resources, tenancy and customer access may be lost

C. Cash transfers always create employment

D. Relocation cannot affect schooling

Answer: B. Economic displacement includes common-property and non-titleholder losses that cash for titled land may miss.

21. Which statement about the Child and Adolescent Labour law is defensible?

A. Every family-business activity is exempt without conditions

B. Adolescent hazardous work is restricted and child-employment exceptions are constrained

C. Children may work at night if paid

D. Education law applies only to employers

Answer: B. The amended framework prohibits most child employment and specifically regulates adolescent hazardous work; exceptions are not blanket permissions.

22. An increase in registered violence complaints necessarily proves what?

A. Incidence increased

B. Trust and reporting improved

C. Neither without additional evidence

D. All interventions failed

Answer: C. Registered counts reflect reporting and recording as well as underlying incidence, requiring triangulation.

23. A programme trains 20,000 youths but reports no retention or wages. Its principal evaluation gap is:

A. Too many outcome measures

B. Lack of evidence about durable employment quality

C. Insufficient certificates

D. No publicity budget

Answer: B. Training completion is an output; job retention, earnings and work conditions test whether livelihoods improved.

24. Which scenario illustrates institutional exclusion rather than only resource scarcity?

A. A village has no nearby health centre

B. A qualified worker is denied an available benefit because of mismatched identity records

C. A drought reduces groundwater

D. A storm destroys a crop

Answer: B. A benefit exists but procedural barriers prevent access, demonstrating institutional exclusion.

25. What is the strongest way to assess flood-risk resettlement?

A. Count demolished dwellings

B. Compare risk, travel cost, income and schooling after relocation

C. Measure only construction speed

D. Count new road signs

Answer: B. Relocation should reduce hazard exposure without creating livelihood or education losses.

26. A falling fertility rate may coexist with population growth mainly because of:

A. Demographic momentum from age structure

B. A necessary rise in mortality

C. Universal migration bans

D. An increase in poverty thresholds

Answer: A. A large cohort entering reproductive ages can sustain births even after fertility per woman declines.

27. How can public employment programmes affect rural bargaining power?

A. By replacing all private jobs

B. By providing an outside wage option when work and payments are reliable

C. By automatically granting land ownership

D. By eliminating monsoon risk

Answer: B. A credible alternative can strengthen wage bargaining, though delays and insufficient availability weaken the effect.

28. Which statement correctly distinguishes regionalism from exclusion?

A. All regional demands violate the Constitution

B. Constitutional claims for representation differ from discrimination against residents by origin

C. Statehood always removes inequality

D. Regional language protection requires violence

Answer: B. Democratic territorial and cultural claims can coexist with equal individual rights; exclusion violates that balance.

29. Why can digital service delivery still reproduce corruption or exclusion?

A. Software eliminates all discretion

B. Opaque eligibility rules and inaccessible grievance systems can centralise gatekeeping

C. Online transactions require no audits

D. Digital identities cannot be incorrect

Answer: B. Technology can reduce some face-to-face discretion while creating new opaque bottlenecks if rules and redressal are weak.

30. A lake restoration project funds beautification but not upstream sewage interception. Its core weakness is:

A. Too much ecological monitoring

B. Treating a visible symptom without controlling pollutant inflow

C. Too many community meetings

D. Overestimating urban population

Answer: B. Without reducing catchment pollution, cosmetic works may fail to improve water quality or ecosystem health.